```
=begin
this is
all a
multiline comment
=end
```

Ruby uses comment syntax at the top of a file for directives that affect how a file is parsed. These are often called "magic comments," and they must appear in the file before the first line of uncommented Ruby code. The syntax of these magic comments is # directive: value.

If you have more than one magic comment, you may put them on separate lines, as long as all of them come before the first line of Ruby code. You may also put them on a single line, delimited by semicolons and surrounded by -*-, this syntax is based on the file configuration syntax used by the Emacs editor.

```
# frozen_string_literal: true
# encoding: big5
```

Or:

```
-*- frozen_string_literal: true; encoding: big5 -*-
```

Here's a list of the magic comment directives Ruby supports:

Comment	Definition
coding	Synonym of encoding
encoding	The default encoding used for string literals in the file, and the encoding of the source code as a whole. Default is utf-8
frozen_string_literal	If true, string literals in the file are automatically created in memory when the file is loaded and are frozen to make them immutable. String literals with interpolation are never frozen. The default is false.
sharable_constant_value	This directive changes the behavior of immutable constants, to allow them to be shared by Ractors. The default value is none, in which case constants are not frozen and can not be shared with Ractors. With the value literal, constants that are assigned literal values will be frozen and can be shared. With the value experimental_copy, constants are automatically copied when shared with Ractors, and with the value experimental_everything, all constant values are sharable. This directive is experimental and likely to change. Unlike the other magic comments this directive may be used multiple times in a file, and is applicable until the next instance of this directive or the end of the scope in which it is declared.
warn_indent	If true, mismatched indentation in the source code triggers a warning when the file is loaded. The default is false, unless Ruby is run with the -w switch, in which case the default is true.

Ruby source files are assumed by default to be written with a UTF-8 encoding, but this can be changed with the encoding magic comment.

You can pipe programs to the Ruby interpreter's standard input stream:

```
$ echo 'puts "Hello"' | ruby
```